

PURPOSE: For the “length to fingertips” dress code rule to be repealed.

INTRODUCED BY: Max Thompson

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE MISSISSIPPI SCHOOL FOR MATHEMATICS AND SCIENCE

SECTION ONE (REASONING):

Although utilizing the length of one’s fingertips to their legs allows for a specified rule that administration can apply for dress code, its application results in unfair enforcement and therefore consequences.

As known, everyone has bodies of a unique size, each with their own different wingspans and leg length. This results in a great variation of where “dress to fingertips” may apply. Consequently, the application of each person restricting the length of their shorts/skirts to their fingertips results in unequal lengths as to what the administration deems as appropriate. This unfair regulation leads to unequal enforcement upon the students of MSMS.

SECTION TWO (SPECIFIC CHANGE):

On Pages 29 and 30 of the Student Handbook (PDF pages 34 and 35), the following will be changed,

DRESS AND GROOMING

Dress and grooming standards are established to ensure that the school climate reflects safety, appropriateness, and a serious focus on learning. We recognize that fashions, styles, and trends evolve; therefore, the school reserves authority in matters which may arise and are not identified within this policy. MSMS staff reserves the right to request students to return to their residence hall to change if attire is deemed inappropriate or potentially disruptive to the educational process. Both Residential Life and Academic Affairs shall enforce this policy. The final authority regarding proper dress and grooming shall be the MSMS Administration.

The following standards must be followed AT ALL TIMES:

- 1) Appropriate undergarments must be worn and should not be visible; and students should not go shirtless;
- 2) Footwear must be worn when outside the residence hall room;
- 3) Clothing may not contain slogans or images which are considered profane or vulgar; or promote tobacco products, alcohol, drugs, or gang affiliation; or are considered insensitive to race, religion, sexual orientation, ethnicity or gender;

4) Leggings that are see-through or have mesh inserts, clothing considered sleepwear/loungewear and pajama jeans may not be worn outside the residence halls or in the 1st floor lobby of the residence halls;

5) Clothing must provide adequate covering:

a. Skirts, dresses, shorts, or similar attire ~~must be finger-tip length while standing and must allow for stooping, bending, and sitting modestly~~ must cover the private areas and the portion of legs parallel to them. The appropriate length must be evident in the front and back and apply while sitting and standing;

b. Muscle shirts, mesh/transparent tops, or low-cut tops are not permitted;

c. Shirts should be long enough that, at all times, they meet the top of the pants or skirt or shorts so that the midriff, lower back, and/or underwear are not exposed;

d. Halters, strapless attire (including off-the shoulder), and spaghetti straps are prohibited; Clothing may not have holes, cuts, slits, rips, or tears that expose or nearly expose underwear or skin above fingertip length.

6) Waistbands must be worn at the waist (no sagging pants);

Clothing, wigs, face paint and other items of attire that could be classified as “costumes” are not appropriate for general school wear, unless being worn during a school-approved day and/or activity. The other dress code guidelines shall still be followed.